

5. MY BANK ACCOUNT

EXERCISE 1- POST READING

Q.1: According to the author, what is the effect upon him of entering a bank to do business?

Ans: According to the author, when he entered a bank he was frightened by everything present there. The moment he passed through the door of a bank and attempted to do business there. He became an irresponsible fool. Everything frightens him. He seems to be afflicted with bank phobia.

Q.2: Why did the author decide to open an account?

Ans: His salary had been raised to fifty dollars a month. He felt that the bank was the only place for it. That's why he decided to open an account. For this purpose, he visited the bank and acted foolishly. The bank phobia made him do so.

Q.3: What was the manager's reaction when the author told that he would like to see him alone?

Ans: When the author told the manager that he would like to see him "alone" he considered him a detective and took him in a private room. When the manager learnt that he is not the detective, he further guessed that he might be from the rival agency. He took the sigh of relief after learning that he had come to open an account.

Q.4: Why did the manager look relieved when he came to know the purpose of the author's visit?

Ans: When the manager knew the purpose of the author's visit he looked relieved thinking that he was a rich man.

Q.6: What mistake did the author make when he wrote the cheque?

Ans: After completing all the formalities of opening an account, the author decided to draw six dollars for the present use. When he was writing the cheque he hadn't recovered his consciousness yet. Consequently, he wrote fifty six dollars instead of six by mistake.

Q.7: Explain the meaning of clerk's questions, "How will you have it?"

Ans: I think, when the clerk asked the author, "How will you have it (fifty-six dollars)", he was meant to make fun of him. It might be possible he was asking whether the author wanted to have note or coins so that his cheque can be cashed.

Q.8: Why was there "a roar of laughter" when the author left the bank?

Ans: No sooner the author left the bank, a roar of laughter was heard. The whole bank staff was laughing at the follies the author had made on account of the fear of unknown.

Q.9: The author, Stephen Leacock, was a respected University teacher and a successful writer. Do you think, this is a true story?

Ans: Stephen Leacock was a well-educated person. Besides this he was a famous humorous writer. I don't think "My Bank Account" is a true story rather it is an invented tale. The author has created such a character just to please his readers. The story shows Stephen's skillful manipulation of humour. However, though the story is fictitious but the problem the author faced in the story is not a rare one nor abnormal. He was suffering from a kind of a phobia due to which he was afraid of going into banks or any public place. His inability and discomfort while interacting with strangers does not depict any

abnormality or lack of confidence rather it is a psychological discomfort or kind of psychological pressure or the fear of the unknown. So, such a situation and condition is possible irrespective of author's qualification and m

Q.10: Why is it wiser to keep one's money in a bank than to hoard it in one's home?

Ans: It is wiser to keep one's money in a bank than to hoard it in one's home because a bank is a safer place as compare to home. Besides this while depositing our money we can earn a reasonable amount of profit.